

# Define the Problem Statements

## Ideation Phase — Problem Definition

|                   |                                                    |
|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Project Name      | Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow |
| Phase             | Phase 1: Ideation                                  |
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| Platform / Domain | ServiceNow / IT Service Management (ITSM)          |
| Academic Year     | 2025 – 2026                                        |
| Maximum Marks     | 2 Marks                                            |

## Problem Statement Framework

Each problem statement is structured using the **I AM / I'M TRYING TO / BUT / BECAUSE / WHICH MAKES ME FEEL** framework, which helps articulate user pain points with empathy and specificity. Four distinct user personas are captured below, representing the breadth of stakeholders affected by the current unautomated network request process.

### PS-1      Persona: An IT Employee / Requester

|                     |                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I AM                | An IT Employee / Requester                                                                                             |
| I'M TRYING TO       | Submit a network access or VPN request quickly and get it approved within the SLA window.                              |
| BUT                 | The process involves sending emails to multiple teams with no single intake point, and follow-ups are entirely manual. |
| BECAUSE             | There is no centralized portal — requests are sent by email or phone, causing delays and lost requests.                |
| WHICH MAKES ME FEEL | Tense, Frustrated, and Unsure about request status and who is handling it.                                             |

### PS-2      Persona: A Line Manager / Approver

|      |                           |
|------|---------------------------|
| I AM | A Line Manager / Approver |
|------|---------------------------|

|                            |                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>I'M TRYING TO</b>       | Review and approve network requests for my team members efficiently and on time.                   |
| <b>BUT</b>                 | Approval requests arrive via informal emails with no structured context or deadline visibility.    |
| <b>BECAUSE</b>             | Other managers or IT leads cannot approve on my behalf when I am unavailable, causing bottlenecks. |
| <b>WHICH MAKES ME FEEL</b> | Disappointed because I cannot act quickly and requests pile up during my absence.                  |

### PS-3 Persona: A Network Engineer

|                            |                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>I AM</b>                | A Network Engineer                                                                                                   |
| <b>I'M TRYING TO</b>       | Execute network configuration tasks clearly and on time with full context about each request.                        |
| <b>BUT</b>                 | Tasks arrive informally with missing details, requiring multiple back-and-forth clarifications with the requester.   |
| <b>BECAUSE</b>             | There is no structured task assignment system — requests arrive from multiple uncoordinated channels simultaneously. |
| <b>WHICH MAKES ME FEEL</b> | Overwhelmed, confused about priority, and concerned about SLA breaches.                                              |

### PS-4 Persona: An IT Administrator

|                            |                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>I AM</b>                | An IT Administrator                                                                                        |
| <b>I'M TRYING TO</b>       | Monitor all network requests, track SLA performance, and ensure compliance across the team.                |
| <b>BUT</b>                 | Request data is scattered across emails and spreadsheets, making reporting and audits extremely difficult. |
| <b>BECAUSE</b>             | There is no audit trail or dashboard — manual tracking consumes significant administrative time.           |
| <b>WHICH MAKES ME FEEL</b> | Concerned about compliance gaps and audit failures due to the complete lack of centralized visibility.     |

## Consolidated Problem Summary

The four problem statements collectively reveal that the absence of a centralized, automated network request management system creates frustration, inefficiency, and compliance risk across all stakeholder groups. The proposed solution — Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow — directly addresses each pain point through structured catalog forms, automated workflow routing, real-time notifications, and comprehensive audit logging.

Reference: <https://miro.com/templates/customer-problem-statement/>